was over Rs 35 lakh crore, or about 17.5 per cent, of the country's national income.

Only a week earlier, the results of the National Family Health Survey (NHFS) 2020 were published for twenty-two states and union territories. It highlighted India's poor nutritional status with widely prevalent child malnutrition, captured in the proportion of children who are stunted (lower height than standard for the age) or getting wasted (lower weight than standard for the height). Several states saw their proportion of stunted or wasted children below the age of five increasing compared to NHFS 2015. Over 10 per cent of India's population still lives in extreme poverty. Poverty and malnutrition have worsened in 2020 owing to widespread job and income losses on account of the slowing economy, lockdown and declining government expenditure.

The contrast between the country's privileged and poor could not be starker. It is heart-rending. In a weird way, the rise of billionaires and increasing number of stunted children in India depicts what has been touted as K-shaped recovery—where one part of the economy sees high growth despite the overall economy going down, whereas the other part of the economy sees much worse economic contraction than the overall contraction depicts.

Wealth and Income (GDP)

GDP broadly measures domestically created income. It is the result of all the work put in and value addition created during the year. Income grows with the growth of GDP.

GDP is a measure of flow that is earned during a period of time by contributing to value addition. Wealth, in contrast, is a stock measure. It is the value of assets, financial and non-financial, owned by a household, corporation or government at any particular point in time.